Warm-up / A question about the menu

Repair the reasoning, not the person

Name: _____ Date: _____

Suggested lesson time: 20 minutes. Work individually, then compare when invited.

Useful words

Fallacy: A recognizable mistake in how an argument supports its conclusion.

Personal attack: Dismissing a claim by attacking the person instead of addressing the relevant reasons.

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: Ari asks, 'Will the new lunch menu cost students more?' Bo replies, 'You complain about everything.' No prices for the old or new menu are provided.

Produce: Write two sentences identifying what remains unanswered and why the reply does not answer it.

Your steps

1. Name the information Ari requested.

2. Explain what Bo discusses instead and why that does not supply the requested information.

Before you finish: Does your explanation return to prices rather than decide whether Ari is a pleasant person?

Your response

Main activity / Does the timetable help attendance?

Name: _____

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: Maya asks, 'What evidence shows the new timetable improves attendance?' Lee replies, 'You just hate change and want our school to fail.' No attendance results have been supplied.

Produce: Explain the unanswered question and the diversion, then write a two-sentence replacement reply.

Your steps

1. State Maya's question in your own words.
2. Explain what Lee discusses instead and why that does not answer the question.
3. Rewrite Lee's reply: acknowledge the missing evidence and propose a relevant comparison. Do not invent a successful result.

Before you finish: Have you addressed attendance rather than guessed Maya's motives? A label is optional; explain the error.

Your response

Exit ticket / A question about a crossing

Name: _____

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: Sam asks, 'Would a new pedestrian crossing reduce near-misses here?' Jo replies, 'Either you support this crossing or you do not care about safety.' No near-miss records or comparisons have been supplied.

Produce: Write one explanation of the error and a two-sentence replacement reply.

Your steps

1. State the safety question that needs evidence.
2. Explain why caring about safety does not require accepting this particular proposal.
3. Write a reply acknowledging the missing evidence and proposing a comparison that could assess the crossing.

Before you finish: Do not confuse supporting an aim with accepting every proposal offered in its name.

Your response